

Unit Y321: The Middle East 1908–2011: Ottomans to Arab Spring

This theme focuses on Middle Eastern developments from the last years of the Ottoman Empire, through the creation of Mandates and successor states, their rivalries, the vision of Pan Arabism, conflict between Arab regimes and popular forces and to the regional and civil wars of the period 1908–2011. This includes the role of the Middle East in the wider world – its resources, global rivalries, the World Wars, the Cold War and as a problem requiring ‘solution’, especially the Arab-Israeli conflict – and the role of religion and the existence of various ethnic groupings. The detail

of specific military conflicts is not expected, although the causes and consequences of these are. The themes identified below should not be studied in isolation to each other. They are not self-contained and questions may cross the identified themes.

Learners are not expected to demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specification content, except for the named in-depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

Thematic Study: The Middle East 1908–2011: Ottomans to Arab Spring	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
The Role of the Great Powers in the Middle East	The aims, policies and methods of Britain and France to 1956 and of Russia and the US to 2011; the role of the League of Nations and the UN; the use of mandates, coups, occupations, allies, bases and client states; Great Power involvement in war from 1914 through the Cold War to the Gulf Wars (1987, 1991 and 2003); the Great Powers and resources: oil, the Seven Sisters, concessions and nationalisation, the Mossadeq Coup 1953, OPEC and oil as a weapon; oil wars and strategy.
Zionism, Israel and the Palestinian issue	Zionist ideas and the impact of the First and Second World War; the Jewish Agency; the creation of Israel and the 1948 War; Arab-Israeli Wars (1956, 1967, 1973) and invasions (Lebanon 1982 and 2006, Gaza 2008); the Occupied Territories Settlements and Wall; Israeli leadership and diplomacy including Sadat, Camp David and Oslo, the Road Map for peace; Palestine to 1948; Palestinian refugees and the impact on Jordan, Lebanon and Gaza; the PLO and Arafat; Intifadas (1987–1993, 2000–2011) and Palestinian divisions; the Palestinian Authority: the West Bank, Gaza, land, water and the conflict over resources.
Statehood and Pan Arabism in the Middle East	The progress of Arabism from 1908; Nasser and the Arab revolution in Egypt and Syria 1954–1970 (Suez, the United Arab Republic 1958–1961); the impact of the Arab-Israeli Wars and regional rivalries; democratic, monarchical and authoritarian States including Atatürk’s secular state and its successors; monarchies including Jordan, Saudi Arabia and the Wahhabi Movement; Syria including the Baathist Movement, the Assads and risings to 2011; Iraq from Faisal to Saddam Hussein and the US; Iran from Shah (1925) to Ayatollahs (1979).

Religion, ethnicity and political Minorities	Sunni and Shi-a in the Arab States; Egypt and the Muslim Brotherhood from 1920; Iran and the Islamic Revolution; Hezbollah and Hamas; Al Qaeda; Christian communities especially in the Lebanon, the Armenians and the Copts; Jewish communities and their attitude to Israel; ethnic groups and minorities including Kurds, Armenians, Jews, Palestinians; the role and influence of the Middle Eastern diaspora.
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Depth Studies	Content Learners should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:
British Policy and the Middle East 1908–1948	British imperial aims pre-1914, the First World War and the partition of the Middle East (Sykes-Picot Agreement, the Balfour Declaration, McMahon-Hussein letters, the Peace Treaties); policy approaches to the British Mandates of Palestine and Transjordan; British oil companies; relations with Faisal and Iraq; relations with Arabs and Jews and the proposed solutions; problems and policy in British Egypt; the impact of the Second World War and the Biltmore Declaration; the reasons for withdrawal from Palestine in 1948.
Arab-Israeli Conflict 1948–1956	Arab attitudes in 1948, particularly towards the Palestinians; the creation of the state of Israel; the reasons for an attack on Israel and the First Arab-Israeli War 1948–1949; the reasons for Israel's survival and Arab attitudes to this (perpetual war); the Suez Crisis of 1956, the Second Arab-Israeli War and the expansion of Israel; the reasons for Israel's success and the impact on the Palestinians (refugees) and the Arab World, especially Egypt, Syria, Jordan and the Lebanon.
Nasserism 1952–1970	Nasser and Pan Arabism; Arab Socialism (nationalisation of industry and finance, land reform and development from above); relations with Britain, France, the US and the USSR; the Suez Crisis 1956; regional rivalry and the Arab Cold War 1956–1963 (Egypt, Iraq and the creation of the United Arab Republic); Nasser and the Non-Aligned movement; 1967 War and the death of Pan Arabism.